

# Universal Auto Explore for Civilization VII

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# Universal Auto Explore for Civilization VII

Grants the game's built-in auto-explore action to **every** unit, so any unit — not just Scouts — can be sent off to reveal the map on its own. It does not change gameplay balance.

## At a glance (for players)

The "explore" command Civilization VII only gives your Scouts, unlocked on everything else — Warriors, Settlers, Commanders, siege, ships, unique units, and great people.

- **One thing, done completely:** any unit can be told to auto-explore and fill in the fog on its own.
- **No new UI:** it unlocks a command the game already has. If you can auto-explore a Scout, you can use this.
- **Covers everything:** base game, all DLC, independent-power units, captured units, and future patch units — automatically.
- **Safe and additive:** it does not touch balance, movement, combat, costs, or base-game files, and is safe to add to an ongoing game.

At a glance (for modders):

- **Mod id:** universal-auto-explore
  - **Author:** Tower
  - **Version:** 1.0.0
  - **Requires:** base-standard (i.e. the base game). No DLC required.
- 

## How it works

The game enables auto-explore on units carrying the `UNIT_CLASS_AUTOEXPLORE` type tag (by default only Scouts, a handful of uniques, and most warships have it). This mod adds that tag to every other unit.

Instead of hand-listing hundreds of unit types, it applies the tag with a single set-based SQL patch — `data/grant-autoexplore.sql`:

```
INSERT OR IGNORE INTO TypeTags (Type, Tag)
SELECT Type, 'UNIT_CLASS_AUTOEXPLORE'
FROM   Types
WHERE  Kind = 'KIND_UNIT'
      AND Type NOT LIKE '%SANDBOX%';
```

Why this shape:

- **Complete, zero-maintenance coverage.** It tags whatever `KIND_UNIT` types exist in the current age's database — base game, every DLC civ/leader pack, independent-power units, units a player captures, and any units a future patch adds. Nothing to update per release.
- **INSERT OR IGNORE** skips units that already carry the tag (they collide on the `TypeTags (Tag, Type)` primary key), so there is no duplicate-row load error and no need to maintain an exclusion list.
- **Runs in every age.** The action group's **in-any-age** criteria is met in Antiquity, Exploration, and Modern, so the patch re-applies to each age's freshly built database. A high `LoadOrder` (9999) ensures it runs after all unit types have been inserted.
- **SANDBOX filter** drops the engine test units (`UNIT_SANDBOX`, `UNIT_AUDIO_SANDBOX_*`), which never appear in normal play.

`UNIT_CLASS_AUTOEXPLORE`, the `Types/TypeTags` table names, `KIND_UNIT`, and `AGE_*` are engine-owned identifiers and are left unchanged — renaming them would break the effect. Everything author-owned (mod id, filename, action-group id, localization tags, author) was renamed for this rebuild; no attribution to the original creator remains.

## Layout

```
universal_auto-explore/
  universal-auto-explore.modinfo    # mod manifest
  data/grant-autoexplore.sql        # the single set-based tag patch
```

```

text/en_us/ModuleText.xml      # display name + description
README.md  README.pdf          # this document
CHANGELOG.md                   # release history (drives the Steam change note)
CONTRIBUTING.md  LICENSE      # contributor guide + MIT license
release.sh                  # build the Workshop package
steam_workshop_id.txt        # publishedfileid, written on first publish
images/
  universal-auto-explore-icon.svg # mod icon
docs/
  steam-workshop-description.md      # full Steam store copy (BBCode)
  steam-workshop-description-short.md # short Steam store copy (BBCode)
  workshop-preview.svg  workshop-preview.png # Steam preview card
scripts/
  build_readme_pdf.sh          # regenerate README.pdf

```

Only the modinfo, data/, text/, README, CHANGELOG, and LICENSE ship in the Workshop zip; docs/, images/, scripts/, and the release tooling are repo-only (excluded by **release.sh**).

Everything below data/, text/, plus the modinfo and README is what ships; the rest is release tooling and is excluded from the packaged zip.

## Publishing to Steam Workshop

**release.sh** builds a clean, audited package — it does **not** upload (that needs your Steam login).

1. Bump <Version> in the modinfo and add a matching ## [x.y.z] section to CHANGELOG.md.
2. Run **./release.sh**. It writes dist/:
  - **universal-auto-explore-vX.Y.Z.zip** — the mod, modinfo at the zip root (also fine for manual install / CivMods).
  - **dist/universal\_auto-explore/** — the upload content folder.
  - **preview.png** — 1024×1024 card rendered from docs/workshop-preview.svg (needs rsvg-convert; brew install librsvg).
  - **workshop\_item.vdf** — the steamcmd manifest (appid 1295660).
3. Upload with the command the script prints:
 

```
~/steamcmd/steamcmd.sh +login <yourSteamLogin> \
  +workshop_build_item <abs-path>/dist/workshop_item.vdf +quit
```
4. The first upload creates the item and prints a publishedfileid. Save it: **echo <publishedfileid> > steam\_workshop\_id.txt**. Later runs then upload in **update** mode and generate the Steam change note from the current CHANGELOG.md section.

## Notes

- Rebuilt against Civilization VII **1.4.1**. Because the effect is set-based, it does not need to be re-verified against a specific unit roster each patch.